

Comprehensive Legal and Institutional Analysis: Managing Security Misconduct, Duty of Care, and Remedial Frameworks in Irish Higher Education

1. Executive Summary and Factual Matrix

The contemporary higher education landscape in Ireland operates at a highly complex intersection of academic governance, commercial enterprise, statutory public safety, and civil liability. Institutions possess a profound duty of care toward their students and alumni, a duty that extends beyond the classroom into the commercial and social spaces operated on campus. This report provides an exhaustive, multi-disciplinary analysis of a severe administrative and legal breakdown at the University of Galway. The factual matrix involves an escalating series of altercations, alleged negligence, and systemic administrative failures directed at a thirty-year-old disabled alumnus—presenting with an anxiety disorder and Complex Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (CPTSD)—by a third-party private security contractor operating at the campus venue, Sult.

The cascading sequence of events highlights critical vulnerabilities in institutional duty of care, regulatory oversight, and vicarious liability. The instigating event occurred in the summer of 2023, when the University of Galway campus security team provided erroneous information to the Sult Operations Manager, falsely claiming the individual was not a registered student. Relying on this negligent misstatement, the Operations Manager instructed a third-party bouncer to remove the individual. Despite the student proclaiming his registered status—an act later falsely characterized as verbal abuse—the bouncer initiated a protracted campaign of harassment. This included chasing the student for hours over multiple days, mocking him with demands to "get the fuck off campus," and attempting to tackle him in a completely different section of the campus, far outside the bouncer's legal and geographical jurisdiction.¹ This extreme escalation caused severe psychiatric injury to the student and led to devastating professional consequences, including the revocation of academic references based on false rumors of a "psychotic break."

Following a period of reconciliation where the student returned to the bar and re-established good terms with the Operations Manager, the situation deteriorated again upon the specific bouncer's return. The operative approached the student—who was eating and studying—and shouted "YOU ARE BARRED" inches from his face, permanently fracturing the student's sense of safety.

The institutional response to these events forms the basis of the ensuing administrative malfeasance. In September 2024, the student submitted a formal QA611 complaint to the Dean of Students, Professor Ciara Meehan. This complaint was allegedly dismissed or covered up,

with the Dean advising that it was "not her issue," despite the direct involvement of the University's own security team in the initial negligent misstatement.² Furthermore, the student reported the bouncer to the Private Security Authority (PSA) in the summer of 2025, highlighting the bouncer's repeated refusal to provide his PSA identification badge number in both 2023 and 2025. The PSA allegedly failed to investigate or remove the bouncer.⁴ This compounded negligence culminated in a severe incident in April 2026. The bouncer, without announcing himself, grabbed the individual from behind. At this juncture, the individual was no longer a registered undergraduate but a valid alumnus, an external user of the James Hardiman Library, and an incoming student for a Master of Science (MSc) in Artificial Intelligence commencing in September. Following this physical assault, the bouncer propagated highly defamatory falsehoods, alleging that the alumnus was inciting group violence, hurting women and students on campus, and trespassing. This report evaluates the extensive liabilities arising from this timeline. It provides a definitive assessment of maximum civil damages for psychiatric injury, physical assault, and defamation, particularly concerning the alumnus's dual standing as a registered postgraduate and secondary school teacher. It further analyzes the criminal implications of the security operative's actions, the viability of judicial review (Order of Mandamus) against state regulators, the specific liabilities of the Dean of Students and the University Security Team, and the precise administrative compartmentalization required to protect the alumnus's upcoming MSc in AI.

2. Institutional Governance, Campus Jurisdictions, and Alumni Access Policies

To accurately establish liability and the illegality of the bouncer's actions, the precise legal and administrative standing of the individual on the University of Galway campus must be definitively delineated. The persistent narrative propagated by the security operative—that the individual was trespassing—is demonstrably false under the University's own governance frameworks.

2.1 Alumnus and External User Access Rights

The University of Galway provides explicitly defined access rights to its alumni and external users, structurally integrating them into the campus community. Under the university's library access policy, QA822 (Accessing the Library), all graduates of the University of Galway are formally recognized as external users and are entitled to free, lifetime access to the James Hardiman Library.⁵ To activate this right, graduates are simply required to complete a Library Membership Form and provide proof of graduation, such as a conferring parchment or academic transcripts.⁶ Once processed, the alumnus is issued an access card that controls entry through the library gates and permits the use of open print collections, individual study spaces, and guest Wi-Fi access.⁶

Therefore, at the time of the April 2026 assault, the individual possessed an absolute, policy-backed right to be present on the campus and to utilize its academic facilities. The assertion of trespassing by the bouncer is a fundamental misrepresentation of the university's

access agreements.

2.2 Commercial Spaces and the Governance of Sult Bar

The operational jurisdiction of campus social spaces further undermines the bouncer's authority to unilaterally bar an alumnus from the broader campus. Sult is the primary social and entertainment venue on the university grounds, providing catering, hospitality, and event spaces.⁷ Crucially, Sult does not operate under the direct administrative control of the University's central academic or security apparatus. Instead, it is managed by NUI Galway Students' Union Commercial Services Ltd (SUCS Ltd), a registered commercial company whose single share is held by the Students' Union Board of Trustees.⁹

As a commercial entity operating a licensed premises, Sult functions as a public accommodation. While the venue management holds the common law right of an occupier to refuse service or ask a patron to leave the specific licensed premises, this right is bounded by equality legislation and does not extend to the broader university campus. There is no statutory mechanism or internal university policy that empowers a third-party contractor employed by SUCS Ltd to issue a blanket campus barring order against a recognized alumnus.¹ The bouncer's decree that the individual was "BARRED" from the university at large was legally vacuous and constituted a severe jurisdictional overreach.

2.3 The Delineation of Security Jurisdictions

Campus safety and territorial integrity are managed by the University of Galway Security Team, which operates under the Buildings Office and provides 24/7 patrol, access control, and emergency response across the estate.¹¹ The University Security Team are direct employees or direct agents of the university.¹¹

Conversely, Sult utilizes third-party private security personnel (door supervisors) specifically for venue management. The jurisdiction of a venue bouncer is strictly geographically confined to the licensed premises (the bar) and its immediate physical entryway. Under the University's Event Management and Event Safety Policy (QA123), third-party security providers must adhere strictly to established safety legislation and are explicitly prohibited from acting as unilateral campus enforcers.¹⁰

The evidence indicates that the bouncer pursued the student for hours over multiple days across completely different sections of the campus.¹ This action nullifies any defense of "venue protection." Once the bouncer left the immediate vicinity of Sult to pursue the individual across the campus, he ceased operating as a door supervisor and became a private citizen engaged in a sustained campaign of harassment and attempted assault.¹² The attempt to physically tackle the student in an area of the campus outside the bar's operational footprint transforms a routine venue-control issue into highly actionable torts of assault, battery, and false imprisonment.

3. The Student Code of Conduct and the Denial of Procedural Fairness

During the initial 2023 incidents, the individual was a fully registered postgraduate student. Consequently, their behavior, access rights, and any disciplinary actions were strictly governed by the University of Galway Student Code of Conduct (QA616).¹ The circumvention of this code by both the university security team and the third-party bouncer forms a critical basis for civil liability.

3.1 The Guarantee of Fair Procedures

The Student Code of Conduct (QA616) is designed to manage discipline systematically and fairly. It explicitly guarantees the right to fair procedures, heavily rooted in the principles of natural justice and constitutional fairness.¹ Under QA616, students are presumed innocent and are guaranteed the right to be formally informed of any allegations against them. Furthermore, they are entitled to a formal meeting or hearing where they can make a defense, and they hold the right to be accompanied by a representative, such as a Students' Union officer.¹

The arbitrary instruction to permanently remove the student, based solely on a negligent telephone call from campus security, represents a catastrophic collapse of due process. Even if the student had engaged in misconduct (which the facts dispute), QA616 dictates that sanctions—including barring from campus facilities—can only be imposed via the formal student disciplinary process following a proper adjudication.¹

3.2 The Mischaracterization of "Verbal Abuse"

The facts state that the student, upon being falsely accused of not being registered, had to proclaim his student status. This self-advocacy was subsequently and incorrectly labeled as "verbal abuse," permanently affecting his reputation. Under the framework of QA616, a student is entirely within their rights to dispute an arbitrary removal order, particularly one based on demonstrable misinformation.¹ The classification of a legitimate defense of one's legal standing as "verbal abuse" is a common retaliatory tactic used by private security to justify excessive force. However, in a legal context, proclaiming one's status does not constitute a breach of the peace or an assault, and cannot be retroactively used by the university or the security firm to justify the bouncer's subsequent multi-day campaign of harassment.

The failure of the University of Galway to intervene and enforce its own Code of Conduct—allowing a third-party contractor to bypass all disciplinary procedures and act as a vigilante adjudicator—represents a fundamental breach of the contract established between the university and the student upon registration.

4. Administrative Malfeasance: The QA611 Complaint and the Dean of Students

A central pillar of the institutional failure in this scenario is the handling of the formal complaint submitted in September 2024. The University of Galway maintains the QA611 Student Complaints Procedure precisely to address systemic failures, operational errors, and staff misconduct. The policy states that it allows for matters to be dealt with fairly, transparently, and in a timely fashion, explicitly providing an avenue for students to raise issues of concern and

seek redress.¹⁵

4.1 The Scope and Mandate of QA611

The QA611 procedure spans many aspects of the student experience, including the quality of services, failure to follow appropriate administrative processes, and crucially, "alleged action or inaction by the University or a member of its staff".¹⁶ The instigating error in the summer of 2023 was committed by the University of Galway Security Team, who are direct university employees. They generated the negligent misstatement regarding the student's registration status that triggered the bouncer's aggression.¹ Therefore, the complaint regarding the origin of the dispute fell squarely within the inviolable scope of the QA611 procedure.

4.2 The Role and Liability of the Dean of Students

Under the QA611 framework, Stage 2 formal written complaints are mandated to be reviewed and managed by the Dean of Students, a position currently held by Professor Ciara Meehan.² The Dean holds strategic responsibility for the student experience and acts as the designated Complaints Officer for the institution.¹⁹

The allegation that the Dean covered up the September 2024 complaint by advising that "it isn't her issue" represents a profound administrative dereliction of duty. While the physical assault was perpetrated by a third-party contractor, the Dean had a strict administrative mandate to investigate the campus security team's role in the misidentification. By refusing to process the complaint, the Dean effectively denied the student their contractual right to administrative redress and institutional protection.

4.3 Foreseeability, Proximity, and Actionable Negligence

In Irish tort law, the establishment of negligence requires proving that a duty of care existed, that the duty was breached, and that the breach caused reasonably foreseeable harm. The relationship between a university Dean and a registered student possesses the requisite legal "proximity" to establish a strict duty of care.

By suppressing the QA611 complaint, the Dean of Students failed to address a known, hostile threat operating on the campus. The complaint served as formal, documented notice to the university that a third-party contractor was engaging in dangerous, ultra vires behavior targeting a specific, vulnerable student. The administrative inaction allowed the bouncer to remain in his position without censure. Consequently, a court would likely view the subsequent assaults in 2025 and April 2026 not as isolated incidents, but as the direct, foreseeable consequence of the Dean's failure to investigate the 2024 complaint. The university, through the actions of the Dean, breached its non-delegable duty to provide a safe campus environment, thereby opening the institution to substantial liability for the subsequent injuries inflicted upon the alumnus.²¹

5. Private Security Authority (PSA) Regulations and Criminal Infractions

The conduct of the bouncer transcends civil liability and enters the realm of severe criminal and regulatory infractions. The security operative's actions present clear grounds for both criminal prosecution by An Garda Síochána and statutory sanction by the Private Security Authority.

5.1 Breaches of the Private Security Services Act 2004

The Private Security Authority (PSA) is the independent statutory body responsible for licensing and regulating the private security industry in Ireland.²³ Under Section 30 of the Private Security Services Act 2004, all licensed individuals—including door supervisors—are legally obliged to visibly wear an identity badge at all times while providing a security service.²⁴

The PSA guidelines provide explicit directives regarding this mandate: the front of the license card, showing the photograph and the individual's unique license number, must be displayed on the upper torso (above the stomach and below the neck) where it can be seen at all times.²⁴

Hanging the badge from a belt or placing it under a jacket is strictly prohibited.²⁶

The facts state that the bouncer repeatedly refused to provide his PSA badge number and actively concealed his identification during the 2023 and 2025 incidents. This is a direct, flagrant violation of Section 30.²⁴ Under the 2004 Act, an individual who contravenes Section 30 is guilty of a criminal offense and is liable on summary conviction to a fine of up to €4,000 and/or imprisonment for a term not exceeding 12 months.²⁷

5.2 Criminal Assault Under the Non-Fatal Offences Against the Person Act 1997

The physical actions undertaken by the bouncer constitute multiple distinct counts of criminal assault under Irish law.

- **Section 2 (Assault):** Under Section 2 of the Non-Fatal Offences Against the Person Act 1997, a person commits an assault if they intentionally or recklessly apply force to another, or cause another to believe on reasonable grounds that they are likely to be subjected to immediate force, without consent.¹² The act of chasing the student across the campus, screaming "YOU ARE BARRED" inches from the student's face, and the April 2026 incident where the bouncer grabbed the alumnus from behind without announcing himself, all clearly meet the statutory definition of Section 2 assault.¹²
- **Section 3 (Assault Causing Harm):** Section 3 of the 1997 Act governs assaults that cause harm. Crucially, the Act defines "harm" as including harm to the body *or mind*.²⁸ The plaintiff in this case suffers from an anxiety disorder and CPTSD. The sustained physical aggression, the multi-day harassment, and the sudden physical grabbing from behind inflicted severe psychological trauma, directly exacerbating these recognized psychiatric conditions. A conviction for Section 3 Assault Causing Harm on indictment carries a severe maximum penalty of up to 7 years imprisonment.²⁸

5.3 Regulatory Failure and the Order of Mandamus

The alumnus appropriately reported the bouncer's misconduct and badge concealment to the PSA in the summer of 2025. As a statutory body, the PSA holds a legal duty under Section 39 of

the 2004 Act to investigate complaints made in good faith against licensees regarding their conduct or alleged contraventions of the Act.³⁰

If the PSA failed to investigate the bouncer or take enforcement action following the 2025 report, they are in dereliction of their statutory duty. To remedy this administrative failure, the alumnus holds the right to initiate Judicial Review proceedings in the High Court under Order 84 of the Rules of the Superior Courts.⁴

Specifically, the plaintiff would seek an **Order of Mandamus**. An Order of Mandamus is a powerful judicial remedy used to compel a public adjudicating body or state regulator to perform a mandatory public duty that it has unlawfully refused or failed to perform.⁴ By securing a Mandamus order, the High Court would legally force the PSA to formally investigate the bouncer's actions, compel the release of his concealed badge number, initiate proceedings to revoke his door supervisor license, and potentially refer the Section 30 breaches to the Director of Public Prosecutions (DPP).

6. Civil Liability and Quantum of Damages: Defamation and Reputational Harm

The civil litigation arising from this complex scenario will pursue multiple interconnected torts. The primary targets for these suits include the bouncer (in a personal capacity), the private security firm employing him, SUCS Ltd (as the venue operator), and the University of Galway (for institutional negligence). The most financially significant aspect of this litigation relates to the profound reputational damage inflicted upon the alumnus.

6.1 The Mechanics of the Defamation Claim

The bouncer and elements of the university security apparatus disseminated highly damaging, false information regarding the alumnus. The false claims included assertions that the individual was not a student, had suffered a "psychotic break," was trespassing, and most egregiously, was causing group-incited violence and hurting women and students on campus.

Under the Defamation Act 2009, a defamatory statement is defined as one that tends to injure a person's reputation in the eyes of reasonable members of society.³³ The plaintiff is not strictly required to show actual financial loss to prove the tort, as the damage to reputation is actionable *per se*.³⁵ The defenses typically available under the 2009 Act—such as truth or fair and reasonable publication on a matter of public interest—will completely fail in this instance. The statements were demonstrably false, and there is no public interest defense for a bouncer inventing allegations of violence against an innocent patron.³⁴

6.2 Professional Aggravation: The Teaching Council Standard

The quantum of damages in this defamation suit is exponentially aggravated by the plaintiff's professional standing. The individual is not merely a student, but a registered disabled postgraduate teacher and a registered secondary school teacher.

The teaching profession in Ireland is strictly regulated by the Teaching Council of Ireland, which enforces a rigorous Code of Professional Conduct.³⁶ Under the Teaching Council Act 2001, any

person can make a complaint about a registered teacher, and the Council can initiate a Fitness to Teach inquiry for conduct occurring outside the immediate course of the profession if the conduct is of a serious nature that brings the profession into disrepute.³⁷

An allegation that a registered teacher is inciting group violence and physically hurting women and students on a university campus is catastrophic. Such rumors strike at the absolute core of the individual's professional integrity, moral standing, and suitability to work with minors or vulnerable adults. The propagation of these falsehoods directly threatens the individual's Teaching Council registration, which is the legal prerequisite for their livelihood. Furthermore, the facts state that these false claims led directly to the revocation of vital academic references, causing immediate and tangible harm to the plaintiff's academic and career trajectory.

6.3 Assessing the Quantum of Defamation Damages

There is currently no statutory cap on the amount of general damages that a High Court jury or judge can award in a defamation action in the Republic of Ireland.³³ To bring consistency to awards, the Supreme Court of Ireland established a framework for assessing defamation damages in the landmark case of *Higgins v Irish Aviation Authority*.³⁹ The framework categorizes defamation into four ascending tiers based on severity:

Defamation Severity Tier	Judicial Description	Financial Range	Relevance to Current Factual Matrix
Level 1	Very moderate defamation.	€0 – €50,000	Inapplicable. The allegations involve severe criminality and moral turpitude.
Level 2	A medium range of cases.	€50,000 – €125,000	Insufficient to capture the professional devastation aimed at a registered teacher.
Level 3	Seriously defamatory material with mitigating factors (e.g., limited sphere of publication).	€125,000 – €199,000	Highly Relevant. If the bouncer's claims were circulated primarily within the campus community and faculty.
Level 4	Very serious defamation causing profound damage to standing.	€200,000 – €300,000	Highly Probable. Falsely accusing a secondary school educator of violence against women/students justifies the highest standard brackets.

Exceptional	Very real damage where the balance tilts decisively toward vindication.	€300,000+	Possible if the court determines punitive or exemplary damages are required to punish the malicious intent. ³⁹
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Given the revocation of academic references, the extreme distress caused, and the direct threat to the plaintiff's Teaching Council registration, a High Court assessment would almost certainly place this defamation in the upper echelons of **Level 3 or Level 4, yielding general damages between €150,000 and €300,000.**³⁹

In addition to general damages for the reputational harm itself, the plaintiff is entitled to claim **Special Damages**. This encompasses precise, calculable financial losses directly linked to the publication.⁴⁰ This would include any lost income from teaching or tutoring engagements that were canceled due to the rumors, the financial value of lost postgraduate opportunities stemming from the revoked references, and out-of-pocket expenses incurred in attempting to mitigate the damage.

7. Civil Liability and Quantum of Damages: Psychiatric and Physical Personal Injury

Distinct from the reputational damage, the plaintiff has suffered severe, documentable psychiatric and psychological injury due to the physical assaults, the multi-day pursuit, and the sustained campaign of intimidation and threat to life ("YOU ARE BARRED" shouted inches from the face; grabbing from behind).

7.1 The Legal Framework for Psychological Trauma

In Ireland, personal injury claims—including those for purely psychological harm—are assessed through the Injuries Resolution Board (IRB, formerly PIAB) before they can proceed to court.⁴² Since the enactment of the Personal Injuries Resolution Board Act 2022, the IRB is fully empowered to assess wholly psychological claims without accompanying physical injury.⁴³ To succeed in a claim for psychiatric injury, the plaintiff must satisfy the rigorous criteria established by the Supreme Court in *Kelly v Hennessy*⁴³:

1. **Recognizable Psychiatric Illness:** The plaintiff must have a formal, clinical diagnosis (e.g., PTSD, generalized anxiety, clinical depression). Ordinary upset, distress, or anger does not attract compensation.⁴⁵ In this case, the exacerbation of the plaintiff's pre-existing CPTSD and anxiety disorder, triggered by the assaults, readily satisfies this requirement.
2. **Shock-Induced:** The illness must be triggered by a sudden, shocking event. The sudden grabbing from behind and the aggressive ambushing while studying fulfill this criterion.
3. **Causation:** The injury must be directly caused by the defendant's act or omission. The "but for" test will easily link the bouncer's violence to the psychological deterioration.
4. **Duty of Care Owed:** The occupier (SUCS Ltd) and the university owed a clear duty of care to ensure the plaintiff's safety on the premises.

7.2 Assessing the Quantum of Psychiatric Damages

The financial value of these injuries is calculated using the Judicial Council's Personal Injuries Guidelines, which came into effect in 2021, replacing the older Book of Quantum.⁴⁶

(Note on Jurisprudence: In early 2025, the Judicial Council proposed a 16.7% inflationary increase to these brackets. However, in July 2025, the Minister for Justice confirmed the Government would not seek Oireachtas approval for this increase.⁴⁷ Therefore, the original 2021 figures remain the strict, mandatory legal standard for assessment).

Under the 2021 Guidelines, psychiatric damage is a standalone category with distinct brackets⁴⁸.

Injury Category	Judicial Description	2021 Guidelines Bracket
Severe PTSD	Permanent effects preventing the injured party from working or functioning at pre-trauma levels. All aspects of life badly affected.	€60,000 – €120,000
Serious PTSD	Significant disability for the foreseeable future, though professional help projects some recovery.	€35,000 – €80,000
Severe Psychiatric Damage	Marked problems with daily activities, sleep, and relationships; very poor prognosis.	€80,000 – €170,000
Serious Psychiatric Damage	Significant ongoing problems, but a more optimistic prognosis than the severe category.	€40,000 – €80,000

The plaintiff's case involves long-term, permanent effects on their sense of safety and comfort on a campus they have utilized since 2011, alongside severe trauma responses triggered by the unprovoked grabbing from behind. The psychiatric damage is therefore highly likely to be classified under **Severe PTSD or Severe Psychiatric Damage**.

In cases of multiple injuries (e.g., the physical bruising from the attempted tackle combined with the severe PTSD), the trial judge or the IRB will identify the most significant injury, value it within its bracket, and then apply an "uplift" to ensure the claimant is fairly compensated for the lesser, overlapping injuries, while maintaining overall proportionality.⁴⁷ The general damages for the personal injury component of this suit alone will likely range between **€80,000 and €150,000**.

When combining the potential defamation award (€150k - €300k), the psychiatric injury award (€80k - €150k), and the quantifiable special damages (therapy costs, lost income, delayed

academic progression), the aggregate civil suit value realistically sits between **€350,000 and €550,000**.

7.3 Vicarious Liability and Apportionment

A critical strategic element of this litigation is establishing vicarious liability. The individual bouncer is likely a "mark of straw"—meaning he does not possess the personal financial assets to satisfy a €500,000 judgment. The plaintiff must pursue the corporate entities involved. Irish courts utilize the "close connection" test to determine if an employer is vicariously liable for the unauthorized, intentional, or even criminal acts of an employee or agent (as seen in *McCamley v Dublin Bus* and *Hickey v McGowan*).⁴⁹

- **The Private Security Firm:** The agency that employs the bouncer is strictly vicariously liable. The assaults and defamation occurred while the bouncer was ostensibly performing his contracted duties of venue control, establishing an undeniable "close connection" to his employment.
- **SUCS Ltd (Sult Management):** As the occupier of the premises and the contracting entity, SUCS Ltd holds a non-delegable duty of care to its patrons. If the management failed to adequately vet, monitor, or terminate a dangerous third-party contractor—especially after the 2023 incidents—they share joint and several liability.⁵¹
- **The University of Galway:** The university faces direct liability for the initial negligence of its security team (who disseminated the false registration status) and the subsequent administrative negligence of the Dean of Students in suppressing the QA611 complaint.

8. Reputational Remediation: Venue Operations and the Offer of Amends

While the protracted civil litigation and regulatory actions proceed, there is an urgent, immediate requirement to restore the alumnus's reputation within the campus environment and ensure unhindered access to commercial and academic facilities.

The Operations Manager of Sult must take proactive, documented steps to clarify the situation to all venue staff. From a legal perspective, this action is formalized under the Defamation Act 2009 as an "Offer of Amends".³⁴ Making a formal Offer of Amends involves offering a suitable correction, a sufficient apology, and an agreement to pay compensation.³⁴

To protect the venue's ongoing operations and mitigate further reputational damage to the alumnus, the Operations Manager should immediately draft and circulate a formal internal memorandum to all security personnel, bar staff, and university Buildings Office liaisons. This memorandum must explicitly state:

1. The individual in question was wrongly identified and falsely accused of misconduct.
2. The individual was a fully registered student during the 2023 incidents.
3. The individual is currently a recognized alumnus of the University of Galway in good standing.
4. The individual possesses the absolute, unencumbered right to enter, utilize, and be served within the Sult venue and all broader campus facilities.

5. Any prior instructions regarding barring or removing the individual are entirely revoked and nullified.

By taking this conversation offline and formalizing the retraction internally, the Operations Manager demonstrates a genuine willingness to resolve the issue, rebuilds trust, and neutralizes the ongoing, dangerous narrative propagated by the rogue bouncer.⁵²

9. Academic Ring-Fencing: Institutional Retaliation and the MSc in AI

The alumnus is slated to commence a Master of Science (MSc) in Artificial Intelligence in September 2026. A paramount concern is ensuring that the highly contentious, multi-party litigation regarding the security assaults does not contaminate their academic progression or result in retaliatory admission revocation.

Under the foundational principles of administrative law and university policy, academic progression and separate administrative/legal disputes must be strictly bifurcated.¹⁶ The relationship between a university and an admitted student is contractual in nature. The University of Galway cannot lawfully bar a student from campus, refuse enrollment, or revoke an offer of admission in retaliation for the student initiating active, legitimate litigation against the institution or its contractors. Such an action would constitute unlawful penalization, a breach of the implied contract of good faith, and a gross violation of due process.⁵⁴

Furthermore, an analysis of the specific requirements for the MSc in AI reveals no unique regulatory hurdles that the ongoing dispute could negatively impact.

- **Garda Vetting:** The University's Garda Vetting Policy (QA231) strictly applies to students who will have access to children or vulnerable adults as a necessary and regular part of their coursework (e.g., medicine, nursing, teaching, social work).⁵⁶ The standard MSc in AI (Course Codes: MSC-MAO or PGC-AIP) focuses on computer science, deep learning, optimization, and abstract AI ethics (Module CT5142).⁵⁸ Unless the student's specific AI research project involves direct contact with vulnerable human subjects, Garda Vetting is not a requirement for enrollment.⁵⁶
- **Fitness to Practice:** Similarly, the University's Fitness to Practice policy (QA232) is designed to ensure the protection of the public in professionally accredited, clinical, or social care placements.⁶¹ It does not apply to abstract computational sciences or AI development.

The student must compartmentalize their interactions. All communications regarding the tort claims, the bouncer, the Dean of Students, and the civil damages must be routed exclusively through their retained legal counsel to the University's Corporate and Legal Affairs office. Conversely, the student should interact with the School of Computer Science and the College of Science and Engineering purely in an academic capacity, focusing solely on enrollment, module selection, and coursework. If any university administrator attempts to conflate the two domains—for example, by threatening the AI enrollment due to the ongoing lawsuit—legal counsel must immediately issue a cease-and-desist correspondence citing the student's contractual right to academic progression and the prohibition against retaliatory action.⁵⁵

10. Strategic Conclusions and Actionable Matrix

The synthesis of the factual matrix, the internal policies of the University of Galway, and the stringent frameworks of Irish statutory and tort law reveals a catastrophic failure of institutional duty of care. This failure was exacerbated by the aggressive, ultra vires, and criminal actions of a private security operative, and subsequently compounded by the administrative malfeasance of senior university leadership.

The data definitively indicates that the disabled alumnus was victimized by a cascade of errors that resulted in profound, legally actionable harm to both their psychiatric well-being and their highly regulated professional standing as an educator.

To achieve comprehensive redress, the following strategic legal and administrative actions are indicated:

1. **High Court Judicial Review (Order of Mandamus):** Immediate filing of an application for leave to seek an Order of Mandamus against the Private Security Authority (PSA). This action will legally compel the state regulator to fulfill its statutory duty to investigate the bouncer's repeated Section 30 badge concealment offenses and the physical assaults, ultimately seeking the revocation of his door supervisor license.⁴
2. **High Court Plenary Summons for Civil Damages:** Initiation of a multi-defendant civil suit (naming the bouncer, the private security firm, SUCS Ltd, and the University of Galway) claiming:
 - **Defamation:** Targeting Level 4 general damages (€200k - €300k) due to the catastrophic professional implications of falsely accusing a registered teacher of violence against women and students, resulting in the loss of academic references.
 - **Psychiatric Personal Injury:** Targeting the highest brackets for Severe PTSD/Severe Psychiatric Damage (€80k - €170k) under the 2021 Judicial Council Guidelines, proving causation via the *Kelly v Hennessy* nervous shock criteria.⁴³
 - **Institutional Negligence:** Specifically citing the Dean of Students' failure to adhere to the QA611 Student Complaints Procedure in September 2024, which foreseeably enabled and caused the April 2026 physical assault.¹⁵
3. **Execution of an Offer of Amends:** A formal legal demand that the Sult Operations Manager immediately draft and circulate an internal directive to all venue staff and security personnel. This directive must unequivocally confirm the alumnus's innocence, their good standing, and their unencumbered right to access the premises, thereby neutralizing the defamatory trespass narrative.³⁴
4. **Enforcement of Academic Ring-Fencing:** Preemptive correspondence from legal counsel to the University's Legal Affairs department, explicitly asserting that the ongoing, multi-party litigation has no bearing on the alumnus's unconditional contractual right to commence, participate in, and complete the MSc in AI in September 2026.⁶⁰

Through aggressive, highly compartmentalized legal action targeting both the regulatory failures of the state (via the PSA) and the tortious failures of the institution and its commercial subsidiaries, the alumnus is positioned to achieve maximum financial compensation, punitive regulatory action against the assailant, and the complete vindication of their personal and

professional reputation.

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